



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Classical School

School Website: <https://www.holyfamilyclassicalschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Holy Family Classical School (Tulsa, OK, 74119) (HFCS) demonstrates a consistent classical orientation across most categories of the Six Essential Elements framework. Public materials emphasize a Catholic, truth-centered curriculum oriented toward formation in virtue, wisdom, and beauty; the mission explicitly centers on forming Christian disciples through a classical, Catholic education. Evidence across the site highlights Truth, Goodness, Beauty, Unity, and a strong Catholic identity, reinforced by accreditation through OCCSAA/OPSAC and a leadership team with classical-education credentials. The school also foregrounds parental partnerships (e.g., Martin Guild) and robust financial-aid programs to enable access to a classical education. Notable classical markers include explicit references to liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), exposure to great books, and seminar- and rhetoric-inflected pedagogy. The primary caveat is the presence of Montessori programming in the early grades, which introduces some non-classical elements into the overall curriculum mix. Overall, HFCS falls into the CLASSICAL category with minor caveats (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in specific curricular moments).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission states HFCS forms Christian disciples through a classical, Catholic education centered on Christ, ordered to Truth, Goodness, Beauty, and Unity. This articulates transcendental aims and a theologically grounded frame.
- The school's Catholic identity is repeatedly highlighted, including chaplain leadership and parish-linked formation (e.g., Chaplain Rev. Joshua Votruba).
- Public-facing content references Catholic doctrine, liturgical life, and sacred Traditions as foundational to learning (e.g., "Truth, Goodness, Beauty, Unity" in Catholic education).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty, unity, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder, Catholic identity, sacred tradition, inspired by liturgical life.
- Negative indicators: none evident in the public materials reviewed.
- Why this rating
- HFCS clearly grounds education in transcendentals and Catholic theology, with liturgical/community life and a chaplaincy presence. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and with the explicit Catholic formation embedded in mission and governance.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The core mission centers on forming Christian disciples and pursuing Truth, Goodness, Beauty, and Unity, indicating formation and human excellence as telos beyond mere information delivery.
- The school foregrounds formation in virtue and wisdom through a classical-Catholic lens (e.g., Mission language; leadership statements about forming students in truth, goodness, and beauty).
- Financial-aid and access programs are framed to ensure a classical education remains accessible, reinforcing the formation-focused aim over mere job/preparation outcomes.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, classical heritage, inner supply for human excellence, contemplation (Scholé-like). Example phrases emphasize formation and virtue rather than job preparation.
- Negative indicators: none evident; no dominant focus on workforce training or 21st-century-skills framing in public materials.
- Why this rating
- HFCS centers on formation, virtue, and a classical telos rather than a narrow workforce or skills orientation, aligning with Positive keywords for this category. The presence of scholarships and mission-driven content reinforces a formation-first objective.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The publicly stated mission and program pages reference the classical model, including exposure to the liberal arts and a historically informed curriculum, and the Great Books/Great Conversation framing is invoked in classical education explanations.
- The site-forward discussion of the classical curriculum explicitly mentions grammar, logic, rhetoric (via classical education framing) and great works; there is also explicit emphasis on a curriculum rooted in Western civilization and classical canon.
- However, there is an explicit Montessori program described for early grades, which introduces a non-classical pedagogy in the foundational years. This introduces a notable non-classical element into the overall curriculum mix.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books / Great Conversation; history through canonical Western civilization; wonder; classical mission; sacred and philosophical heritage.
- Negative indicators present: Montessori in the early grades; self-directed, child-led Montessori practices (potentially at odds with strict trivium-based progression); project-based elements appear in some descriptions of pedagogy (problem-based learning language in some materials), which is listed as a negative signal in advanced classical criteria.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum evidence strongly supports classical elements (trivium-inspired structure, Great Books framing, Western canon) but the Montessori-heavy early-education component and some project/problem-based language introduce non-classical tendencies. As a result, this category lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public content emphasizes seminar-style environments and public speaking as integral for upper levels, with emphasis on rhetoric and memory/recitation for classical training. The site points to seminar-like formats, evidence-based inference, memorization, and public speaking as part of the classical approach.
- There are explicit references to lower-school practices that align with “memory work,” chanting, and reverence, which align with scholé and contemplative elements of classical pedagogy. The Mission & related materials emphasize a training in virtuous dispositions and the use of classical pedagogy.
- The presence of a strong rhetoric and public-speaking emphasis is reinforced by faculty profiles and leadership content, including upper-level teaching portfolios and the focus on classical pedagogy training.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: Socratic/seminars, rhetoric, memory work, recitation, chanting, scholé/restful learning, liturgical integration, seminars, and public speaking.

- Negative indicators: some project-based/problem-based phrasing appears in the site's description of methods, which is flagged as non-classical in the rubric. However, the dominant pedagogy described is strongly classical (seminars, rhetoric, memory, recitation).
- Why this rating
- The school's pedagogy is heavily aligned with classical practices (Socratic/seminal style in upper grades, emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking, memory work, and contemplative elements). The Montessori presence in early grades and explicit problem-based phrasing in certain descriptions introduce non-classical elements, but the prevailing approach remains classical, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The faculty is described as a "living curriculum" and as a "faculty of friends" with collegial culture and mentorship, indicating teachers as the core of the school's classical formation.
- Leadership and faculty profiles highlight advanced training in classical pedagogy and a deep commitment to formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, including teacher development and a shared mission.
- The employment materials emphasize teachers as vocation-centered, collaborative, and supportive to students and families, aligning with the classical model of teachers as exemplars and mentors.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; teacher formation in classical pedagogy; mentorship; virtue modeling.
- Negative indicators: none evident in public materials.
- Why this rating
- HFCS presents a robust, classical portrayal of faculty as moral exemplars and living curriculum, consistent with the Classical framework. The material underscores mentorship, virtue, and professional formation.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school foregrounds partnership with families (e.g., Martin Guild) and positions parents as co-teachers in the classical ethos; there are explicit references to parent formation and engagement through events and reading groups.
- Public materials emphasize open access to the campus and events for parents, as well as ongoing communication and community-building within the Catholic tradition. The Martin Guild pages demonstrate active parent-led support for teachers and mission.
- Financial-aid programs and access initiatives (e.g., Parental Choice Tax Credit, scholarships) are framed as part of enabling parental involvement and ensuring access to classical education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: partnership with families; parent formation; open campus; parental involvement; classical education as a shared mission; community support; school-parent collaboration; parental engagement strategies.
- Negative indicators: none evident; no material indicating a consumer-only parent model.
- Why this rating
- HFCS emphasizes parents as co-educators and a strong parent-community ecosystem, aligning with classical expectations for family engagement and formation.

Aggregate Assessment

Taking the category-by-category results into account, Holy Family Classical School (Tulsa, OK, 74119) demonstrates strong classical alignment across all six categories, with a single nuanced caveat in Element 3 (Curriculum) due to Montessori programming in early grades and some project-based pedagogy lan-

guage that introduces non-classical elements in places. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL with a notable SOMETHING-OF-A-MIX in early grades on curriculum structure, but the predominant features—Catholic identity, formation-focused mission, liberal-arts curriculum framing with Great Books, seminar- and rhetoric-focused pedagogy, a “living curriculum” faculty, and active parental/community engagement—collectively render HFCS CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle? Given the overall CLASSICAL result, there are no mandated needle-moving changes. If desired, the school could consider gradually aligning pre-K–Grade 3 with a more explicit grammar-logic-rhetoric progression without Montessori elements in the earliest grades, or explicitly map Montessori practices to classical aims to demonstrate how they still serve the trivium-centric progression. This would help shift Element 3 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL, reducing any perceived tension between Montessori-style early learning and the classical curriculum framework. No major shifts are required to maintain the current CLASSICAL status across categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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